



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

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1. Introduction

Force applicants who have taken the Oath of Office are deemed to be on probation for the first two years of their service in the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF). During this probationary period, the Probationer Constable is expected to master the knowledge, tasks, duties and responsibilities of the rank as set out in the Constabulary Force Act, the Police Service Regulation of 1961, Book of Rules and other JCF policies and procedures. During this period, the Probationer must demonstrate such qualities that are likely to render him/her an efficient member of the Force. The Jamaica Constabulary Force has the strategic vision of becoming a high quality professional service that is valued and trusted by all the citizens of Jamaica. The input of each member of the organization, including probationary constables, is critical to the achievement of this goal.

One of the methods used by the organization to promote the development of Probationers is through interaction with their Divisional Training Sub-Officers (DTSOs) via lectures. Unfortunately, there is a reality where the Probationer Constable is sometimes not afforded the prescribed contact time necessary to address developmental issues. In some instances Probationers conclude duties in the morning (night shift) and then proceed to be lectured. In other cases they are dispatched for duty on completion of lectures or days-off are used as lecture days. This practice has led to a plethora of incidents that have staggered the development of the Probationer into an efficient Constable.

The proper supervision of Probationary Constables is also essential to their growth and development. It is expected that supervisors will share experiences and knowledge gained on the job to help guide decisions and actions taken by the Probationers. Based on feedback and observations, it has been noted that probationers are not benefitting from the value of being properly supervised at all times, as often times they are sent on the road with their batch mate(s) or another probationer who may have graduated few months before them or a member, who based on their conduct, is in need of supervision.

After leaving NPCJ some probationers are posted in locale that are new to them, their limited local knowledge restricts them and in turn limits their effectiveness; working with a colleague in the similar position is not ideal. Current realities of no supervision, improper supervision, not being released for probationary lectures, and not being properly mentored, etcetera have helped to stagger the growth and development of probationers and by extension the organization. It is imperative that all Probationers are managed in a way that promotes the highest efficiency and effectiveness of the organization.

2. Purpose

This policy outlines administrative procedures and guidelines for the training, development and management of probationary constables.

3. Scope

This policy applies to all members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) who are directly or indirectly involved in the management, training, supervision and general development of probationer constables attached to their formation. It will operate as the guide to the management of all their activities after they have graduated from the

Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

National Police College of Jamaica until their confirmation in the rank. Additionally, this policy will serve as a guide to probationers in relation to their responsibilities and entitlements during the probationary period.

4. Definitions:

- 4.1 Divisional Training Sub-Officer: A specially designated sub-officer of the rank of Inspector or Sergeant who has completed relevant training and is certified by the Director of the National Police College of Jamaica.
- 4.2 Probationer also referred to as Probationary Constable: is a member of the Jamaica Constabulary Force who is not yet confirmed in the enlisted rank.
- 4.3 Probationary Period: is the time from which the Force Applicant takes the Oath Of Office until they are confirmed in the rank of constable. The probationary Period is at least twenty four months for the probationary constable.
- 4.4 Supervisor: A Sub-officer or senior constable immediately in charge of the Probationary Constable while they are on duty.

5. Policy Statement:

- 5.1 It is the policy of the Jamaica Constabulary Force that Probationary Constable must be treated respectfully, humanely, and be given every opportunity to enhance their growth and development in order to transform them into effective, efficient and professional members of the JCF.
- 5.2 Probationers must be initially posted at a geographic division.

6. Policy

Process of Probationer Training

The Probationary period is two (2) years from the date of enlistment; it is done in (4) phases which consists of probationers transitioning into operational duties; progressing from trainees needing 'very close' supervision to finally being adjudged an 'effective member'.

- 6.1 **Phase I**, also referred to as Basic Training lasts for six months at the National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ). On successful completion, the probationer is assigned to a geographic division of the JCF.
 - 6.1.1 One week before probationers are transferred to their divisions, the DTSOs must convene a meeting at the National Police College of Jamaica with the probationers assigned to them.
 - 6.1.2 This meeting will sensitize probationers about their divisions, outline expectations and discuss welfare matters.
- 6.2 **Phase II** marks the first stage of the probationary training period in the assigned division, it is a continuation of Basic Training and is designed to

Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

expose and provide probationers with on the job training and experiences for a period of six months. It is expected that at this stage probationers will garner new knowledge and experiences from multiple sources to positively impact their personal and professional growth.

- 6.4 **Phase III** of the Probationary period commences immediately after the second phase and lasts for an additional six months. This phase holds invaluable keys to the understanding of specific policing issues, skills and organizational behaviours; all geared towards best practices, professional growth and development. Consequently, psychological and cognitive insights will undoubtedly enhance the delivery of this phase of training aimed at improving probationers' abilities to better appreciate the contributing factors to effective policing.
- 6.5 **Phase IV** is the final stage of the probationary period, lasting for six months; is intended to culminate all previous stages to equip probationers with the appropriate knowledge, skills and attitudes which are required for them to perform effectively as professional police officers. This phase will provide the Opportunities for the Probationers to acquire higher knowledge and understanding of all areas of policing relative to the constitutional laws and police procedures of Jamaica. On successful completion of this phase the probationer will be adjudged an effective member. See appendix 1.

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6.2 Lectures

- 6.2.1 Administration Officers, Duty Sub-Officers and DTSOs must ensure that all Probationers are detailed for lecture, as their duty, whenever probationary lectures are scheduled.
- 6.2.2 DTSOs must ensure the following areas are addressed at lectures:
- a. Force Orders (Part 1)
 - b. Presentation from syllabus or other relevant topic(s)
 - c. Case File Preparation
 - d. Consultation with probationers relative to areas for improvement and feedback from other supervisors or managers.
- 6.2.3 DTSOs must submit a weekly return of lectures conducted and topics covered, etcetera to the Probationers' Training Office at NPCJ. Template attached at Appendix 2

6.3 Examination, Course Work and Assessments

- 6.3.1 A written examination, set by the Probationers' Office at NPCJ, will be administered to Probationers at the end of each phase. This examination accounts for 40% of the final grade.

- 6.3.2 A probationer who fails the written examination for any phase must be served a warning notice (Appendix 3) and must be allowed the opportunity for one re-sit examination.
- 6.3.3 If the member fails the re-sit examination, a comprehensive report on the work, worth and conduct of the member along with a recommendation from the Divisional Commander must be submitted to the ACP NPCJ for further action.
- 6.3.4 A Probationer who is administered a re-sit examination must only be afforded the minimum passing grade.
- 6.3.5 The remaining 60% accounts for course work. The course work that is given for each phase includes the completion of at least five (5) case files (including sudden death and traffic accident).
- 6.3.6 Assessment and Interview of the Probationers will be done by the Commanding Officer and Administrative Officer for each phase. This will employ the use of all the relevant forms attached to Appendix 4,
- 6.3.7 Probationers' reports for Phase IV, the final phase, must be submitted at least two (2) months prior to the date of confirmation to Deputy Commissioner of Police in charge of Administration.

6.4 Orientation

- 6.4.1 Probationers' Orientation is a structured period that is designated for all probationers to be exposed and actively engaged in police duties at the Guardroom, Criminal Investigation Branch (C.1.B), Community Safety and Security Branch (CSSB), Traffic Department and Detention and Courts. They should be awarded the opportunity to be at each named department for one month to gain sufficient experience to enhance their policing knowledge and competence.
- 6.4.2 The probationers should do their orientation at guardroom and traffic department during Phase II of the training period. Orientation at CSSB and C.1.B is to be done during Phase III.
- 6.4.3 Activities that they are to be engaged in at the various areas:

6.4.4 Reception Area (Guardroom):

- i. Statement (taking and writing)
- ii. Report (taking and writing)
- iii. Diary entry (threat, assault occasioning bodily harm, etc.)
- iv. Proper use of the communication devices (telephone, based radio, etc.)
- v. Courts duties
- vi. Cell duties
- vii. Practice of proper customer service

6.4.5 Criminal Investigation Branch

- i. Statement writing
- ii. Report writing
- iii. Investigation of offences (murder, shooting, robbery, etc.)
- iv. Case file preparation
- v. Crime Scene Management
- vi. Giving evidence in court

6.4.6 Community Safety and Security Branch

- i. Assist with the Safe School Programme (School Resource Officer being involved in the maintenance of a safer school, violence management and antisocial behaviour, etc.);
- ii. Actively involved in Police Youth Club;
- iii. Participation in Neighbourhood Watch;
- iv. Visit communities and family members who are victim(s) of crime(s);
- v. Participate in organizing and attending Community meeting (Widely Publicized Meetings, etc.).

6.4.7 Traffic Department

- i. Traffic management;
- ii. Investigation of traffic offences (traffic accident);
- iii. Court attendance;
- iv. Records Management;
- v. Detecting and prosecuting offenders for traffic violation.

6.4.8 Probationary Constables must not be assigned to any section beyond one month.

6.5 Performance Management

- 6.5.1 Divisional Training Sub-Officers must implement the Performance Management Appraisal System (PMAS), when probationers arrive in the division, to assist with the tasking and appraisal of probationary constables during their probationary period.
- 6.5.2 **Court cases:** Each Probationer must make at least 15 cases for each phase of their probationary period totalling 45 for the probationary period. The DTSOs and Supervisors are to manage the process for quality assurance (proper procedures are followed, timely submission of case files, etc).
- 6.5.3 **Traffic Tickets:** Additionally, each probationer is expected to complete at least three ticket books per phase.
- 6.5.4 A sample of a Probationer's job description and individual work plan is attached at Appendix 5 and 6.

Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

6.6 PROBATIONERS AND OPERATIONAL DUTIES

6.6.1 **Briefing:** Probationers must be briefed by a Supervisor before they are deployed for duty. The briefing must include: Use of Force, Public Interaction, Diversity and all other relevant policies which will be employed on the tour of duty.

6.6.2 **Dress Code:** Probationers will dress according to the occasions mentioned.

6.6.3 Working **Dress should be worn during the stipulated period for:**

- 6.6.3.1 Patrol Duty;
- 6.6.3.2 Court Duty;
- 6.6.3.3 Ordinary Inspection Duty;
- 6.6.3.4 General Duties;
- 6.6.3.5 Any other duty as may be ordered.

6.6.4 **Ceremonial Full Dress:**

- 6.6.4.1 Reviews;
- 6.6.4.2 Guards of Honour;
- 6.6.4.3 Church Parades;
- 6.6.4.4 Opening Day of Circuit Courts.
- 6.6.4.5 Visits of His Excellency, the Governor General to Divisional Headquarters;
- 6.6.4.6 Any other duty as may be ordered.

6.6.5 **Issuance of Weapons:**

Probationers must be issued with firearms, including high powered weapons, which they are qualified to use. Their qualification must be established by the presentation of their Firearm Booklet to the Sub-officer issuing the firearm.

6.6.6 **Supervision:** Probationers must not be deployed for duties without a supervisor.

6.6.7 In cases where the number of sub-officers is limited, the probationers must be given a practical demonstration of what is expected of them during the specific duty and must be monitored periodically by supervisors.

6.6.8 Supervisors must ensure that when probationers are involved in incidents the relevant diary entries, statements (including INDECOM, BSI and CIB, where necessary) are written and the appropriate actions taken.

6.6.9 **Assignment:** Probationers must not be placed on squads or operational support teams beyond one month.

6.7 Confirmation of probationer

6.7.1 When probationers are posted to Police formations, it is anticipated that the Commanding Officers and Team (Administration Officer, DTSOs) will recognize the investment made in these individuals and will see to their welfare and development over the period of their probationary training.

6.7.2 The Police Service Regulation, 1961 24 (6) guides that, on first appointment to the Force a constable shall:

6.7.2.1 During the period of his training be deemed to be on probation, and if during that period he is in the opinion of the Commissioner found wanting in any such qualities as are likely to render him a useful member of the Force, his services may forthwith be dispensed with by the Commissioner; and

6.7.2.2 At the end of the period aforesaid if his services have not been dispensed with, be deemed to have been duly confirmed as respects his enlistment.

During the probationary period, the work and conduct of the Probationary Constable should be closely monitored to determine his/her suitability to continue to be a member of the Force. Where, in the opinion of the Divisional/Commanding Officer, such Probationer Constable is not suitable to be a member of the Force, the circumstances which gave rise to such opinion should be reported immediately to the Commissioner of Police through the appropriate channel.

6.7.3 In instances, where a probationer displays negative traits relative to his/her conduct, performance or health, steps are to be taken to initiate and maintain a dossier on the member. The probationer is to be exposed to counselling if necessary and breaches of discipline dealt with at Orderly Room or recommended for Court of Enquiry promptly.

6.7.4 if the probationer persists in displaying negative tendencies, then a notice is to be served on the member highlighting the deficiencies which are to be supported by facts such as:

(a) conduct -as reflected in number and nature of defaults proven at Orderly Room and those pending;

(b) health - as reflected in the quantum and pattern of sick leave taken over a specific period;

(c) attitude to members of the public - as reflected in number of complaints lodged against the member;

(d) lack of productivity - as reflected in output based on the nature of duties assigned, etc.

Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

Notices served on probationers must indicate the intention of the Commanding Officer if the probationer fails to show the requisite improvement over the period specified. The member should also be afforded the opportunity of responding to the issues highlighted.

- 6.7.5 At one year (1) and ten (10) months service, Divisional/Commanding Officers shall report on all Probationer Constables under their command concerning their suitability to be confirmed.
- 6.7.6 Commanding Officers are to be mindful that the termination of a probationer's service may be recommended at any stage of their probationary period. However, the final report as to his/her suitability for confirmation or otherwise is to be submitted at one (1) year and ten (10) months service.
- 6.7.7 Commanding Officers must act decisively in treating with recalcitrant probationers within the specified period since failure to do so will impact negatively on the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
- 6.7.8 Letter of confirmation -Each Probationer who has successfully completed his/her period of probation and is confirmed in the rank of constable is to be issued with a confirmation letter as attached at appendix 7.

6.8. Extension of the Probationary Period

- 6.8.1 The probationary period may be extended by the Deputy Commissioner of Police incharge Administration and Support Services Portfolio, in the event that the preceding guidelines are not adhered to. The period may also be extended in the following circumstances.
- 6.8.2 Pregnancy; leave will be in keeping with the Maternity Act of Jamaica. Employees are entitled to maternity after completion of one year of employment. 56 days are allowable by Law.
- 6.8.3 Extended sick leave due to duty related injuries or accidents that interrupt the probationary period,
- 6.8.4 Any other legitimate and proven circumstance that prevents the probationer from completing the number of contact hours necessary for his or her assessment.

6.9 Responsibilities of the Probationer

- 6.9.1 The Probationer Constables are responsible for their behaviour, learning and achievements for the successful completion of their probationary period; they must:
- 6.9.2 take responsibility for their growth and development as a Constable by promptly investigating reports made to them and where appropriate effect Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

arrests, prepare case files and attend court as required; support and engage in Community Based Policing activities.

- 6.9.3 Attend ALL lectures for which they are detailed over their probationary period.
- 6.9.4 Be responsible and accountable for all uniforms, equipment and other government properties entrusted to them for personal and general use.
- 6.9.5 Be responsible when dealing with government and civilian property as laid out in Force policy.
- 6.9.5 Maintain the professional standards of the JCF during interaction with customers, paying particular attention to: Citizen's Charter; Firearm, Use of Force and Human Rights Policy; Police Public Interaction and Diversity Policies.
- 6.9.6 Keep their private life unsullied and in accordance with the Code of Ethics of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
- 6.9.7 Exercise due diligence while on duty, paying particular attention to safety procedures at all times to ensure the safety of themselves, colleagues and members of the public.
- 6.9.8 Seek the appropriate leave to be absent from lectures, duty, or any other activity for which they are detailed; in the case of illness submit a valid medical certificate to the Sub-officer in charge of the station within 48 hours.
- 6.9.9 Adopt and support the conservation practices of the Force.
- 6.9.10 Not associate or pursue relationship(s) with person(s) of questionable character that are likely to bring the Force into disrepute.
- 6.9.11 Annually declare their assets in compliance with the Corruption Prevention Act.
- 6.9.12 Seek guidance from knowledgeable and honourable members of the organization.
- 6.9.13 Shun all influence and efforts intended to sway them from their obligations of the Oath of Office and duties as a Constable.
- 6.9.14 Abide by Regulation 45(2)(3) Part I of the Second Schedule of the Police Service Regulations, 1961, which states that: "Refusing or neglecting to pay any lawful debt, is an offence to be dealt with summarily".

6.10 Leave Entitlement

- 6.10.1 According to the JCF Book of Rules; the entitlement for leave are as follows:

- 6.10.2 Vacation Leave: Each member of the JCF is entitled to 28 days per year for the first three years of employment and thereafter 35 days per year.
- 6.10.3 It is a member's responsibility to apply for leave which shall be granted based on the exigencies of the service.
- 6.10.4 In case where leave is not approved a member is also responsible for applying for further accumulation of leave at 105 days. Further delay of leave requires application to accumulate up to 175 days. Thereafter, the member will cease to earn leave.
- 6.10.5 Probationary Constables are entitled to leave as aforementioned however, due to the need for assessment, orientation, lectures, etc., during the probationary period, Probationers must be confirmed before they are given vacation leave. In extreme circumstances the Commanding Officer will decide if they should be facilitated. In such an event their probationary period may be extended.
- 6.10.6 Departmental Leave: 14 days departmental leave per year.
- 6.10.7 Sick Leave: 28 days per year
- 6.10.7 Maternity leave —
- 6.10.7.1 A probationer with less than 12 months service is not entitled to maternity leave.
- 6.10.7.2 A probationer with over 12 months service is entitled to (56) days on the presentation of an appropriate medical certificate and all the vacation leave to which they may be entitled;
- 6.10.8 Leave without pay for an additional period not exceeding ninety (90) days. Notwithstanding the foregoing, the Commissioner of Police or the Permanent Secretary may in any particular case authorize the grant of leave without pay for maternity purposes in excess of ninety (90) days. In addition, sick leave may be granted for maternity purposes on the presentation of satisfactory medical evidence that the illness does not result directly or indirectly or specifically from pregnancy (Book of Rule; 4.19).
- 6.10.9 Study leave: Probationary Constables are not entitled to study leave. Force Orders No. Part I, Sub. No. 7 dated 2015-10-29 treating on pursuing courses of study is attached for guidance at Appendix 8.

6.11 Divisional Training Sub-officers

- 6.11.1 Management by NPCJ - DTSOs are pivotal to the capacity building process of the Jamaica Constabulary Force; their responsibility for the training and development of police officers and the management of probationers at the divisional level is essential to the progress of the JCF as it seeks to maintain a professional organization through training, re-training and demonstration of high standards and conduct. One of the major challenges that is impacting on Probationers' Training, Development and Management Policy

the functions of the DTSOs is their detachment from the main training entity (National Police College of Jamaica) of the organization, currently, DTSOs are selected at a divisional level and are managed by the Commanding Officer in their division. DTSOs are not considered at the divisional level as an extension of the NPCJ, Additionally,

6.11.2 Tasks: DTSOs are often given other tasks/duty that detracts and/or conflicts and/or interfere with the job of training and development; which in itself is a full-time position. This results in training and development not being treated with prestige and the job of the DTSOs is reduced down to just handling probationers.

6.11.3 This policy requires that the management of all DTSQs is the direct responsibility of the Officer in charge of Training Branch. DTSOs should then be 'out-sourced' to the various divisions. Hence, issues of deployment, leave, transfer, etc will be the priority of the officer in charge of training. This will facilitate better management of DTSOs and reduce 'role-conflict' which often arises as the functions of DTSO duties are given secondary focus.